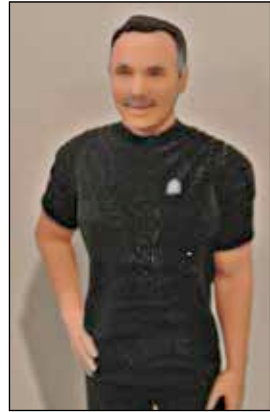


on a mug that was made blank, but with 3D printing the mug can be made to sleekly fit the hand of its user if so desired. Any number of personalised features can be included in a wide range of products without the need for large scale mass production.

Using consumer scale 3D printers that can come for as low as USD \$1000 (Rs.62,000) in the market, designers are producing goods for their customers both locally and through shipping. With the benefits of e-commerce, the ability to connect unique designs with far away clients makes independent business opportunity possible for a wide variety of digital artisans. Currently most of these business' are confined to areas where 3D printers are sold, which is mostly America and parts of Europe, but with the regional interest in Asia and India specifically on the rise, the possibilities are still fertile.

Already companies like SOLS, Matter Labs and Shapeways are emerging players in the western market who are providing the benefits of 3D mass customisation to their customers. From mobile phone cases to orthotics for doctors, these companies are catering directly to the needs of everyone by reducing the cost of personalised products.

Normally doctors would require access to a USD \$25,000 (Rs. 15,50,000) 3D imaging machines to provide their patients with custom made foot orthotics, but now with a free iPad app and 3D scanning, they can do



Visitors at CES 2014 were able to get themselves printed as Star Trek action figures. Shut up and take my money!

the same for less than USD \$500 (Rs.30,000). And even though high grade prosthetics are still made in better quality using injection moulding techniques, those made by 3D printers are a more cost effective solution for those who can't afford the former. In time, SOLS - a company that creates these orthotics - is looking to develop



Machine made body parts bring us one step closer to moving beyond the weakness of flesh.